

OBSERVANCE OF THE DESECRATED SHRINES 05. BROOCHET/JUNE, 2019



ZUFIEGE ZUM JOE MAREK UN ZUM BRIAN WEIS
REV - 0 - 2012

Honoring: Dunner (Thor), Stoffo ("SHTOOF-oh), Jecha ("YEKH-ah"), Lohra ("LOH-ra"), Reto ("RET-oh"), Biel ("BEEL") and all deities whose shrines were desecrated or destroyed through zealotry

Die Aarufing

Intonation of the Runes

Each rune is intoned thrice: Fehu, Kenaz, Elhaz/Algiz

Die Heiliching

*Sichel, heilich daer Aldaar un die Schtell
Beschitzt uns mit der Graft vun de Ziewe
Bei Wudan un Frigg fer der Gemeeschaft zu baue
Bei Ziu un Zisa fer die Gerechdichkeet
un der Fruchsfriede zu erhalde
Bei Ing un Frouwa fer die Wohldaat zu beile
un zu sammle
Bei Dunner un Siwwa fer es Volk vollzumechtige.
Bei de Fraae Berchta un Holle fer es Volk
zu erneire
Wie schmittet der Hammer die Sichel,
So die Sichel der Hammer fiedert.
'S iss es Lewesraad, zu saehe un zu schneide
Sichel, heilich daer Aldaar un die Schtell!*

*Sickle, make holy this altar and this site.
Protect us with the craft of the Deities
By Wudan and Frigg to build the community
By Ziu and Zisa to keep justice and frith*

*By Frey and Freya to cut and to gather
the bounty
By Dunner and Siwwa to empower the people
By the Ladies Berchta and Holle to renew
the people
As the Hammer forges the Sickle
So the Sickle feeds the Hammer
It is the Cycle of life, to sow and to reap
Sickle, make holy this altar and this site.*

*Heel!
Heel!
Heel!*

*Hail!
Hail!
Hail!*

Unser Zweck - Our Purpose

Today we gather to remember and to honor the many gods and goddesses whose sacred shrines, temples, and images were desecrated or destroyed through acts of zealotry. This date was chosen because it is the day the feast day of St. Boniface, who was responsible for the destruction of the ancient Thor's Oak (Dunnereiche) in Hesse. The Church's own lore tells the story:

There stood at Geismar, not far from Fritzlar and Buraburg, an oak of extraordinary size, which was dedicated to Thor or Thunar, "the God of Thunder," and was called Thunar's oak, or Donnereiche, i.e., Thor's oak, or the Thunder oak. Here from time immemorial the Hessians were wont to assemble for the worship of Thor. In the immediate vicinity was Wuodensberg (afterwards called Udenesberg, and later still Gudensberg), a conical hill, on the top of which was a circle of stones, within which the worship of Woden was carried on. Thus the place was the chief sanctuary of the Hessians, and had a character of peculiar sanctity. And as the principal town of the province, Maden or Mattium, where the national assemblies met, was in the neighborhood, it was the most fitting place for an open attack on the popular worship.

Having made up his mind to fell this oak, Boniface repaired to the spot with his monks, not carrying as usual the Holy Scriptures in his hand, but armed with the formidable German axe. He made no secret of his purpose, and the report of the intended sacrilege quickly spread around. Thousands of Pagans flocked to the place, a few the most zealous bent on preventing the offence to the god, but by far the greater part trusting to the god to revenge himself by striking his enemy dead on the spot; while others, whose belief in the gods had been shaken, watched anxiously for the result on which on which their faith was suspended; and others again, looked confidently for the triumph of their newly-found religion. Every eye was riveted on Boniface as he approached the sacred spot and amid solemn, breathless silence raised his arm, and struck a vigorous blow. The mighty trunk quivered, the branches shook, and a deep groan burst from the excited crowd. Then the monks fell to. Blow followed blow, and the trunk was well nigh half cloven, when suddenly, in the topmost branches, was heard a rushing sound as of a whirlwind, and the giant of the forest toppled over, fell to the earth with a thundering crash which shook the whole forest, and echoed again and again from the Wuodensberg, and in the fall its whole length split into four parts. But Boniface and his little band stood unharmed...

Of course, there is no mention of a small army protecting Boniface as he engaged in this action.

To add to the desecration, Boniface and his monks used planks from the oak to build an oratory dedicated to St. Peter.

The Church's lore also states that he "destroyed many idol temples, and erected Christian churches and monasteries in their stead. Prior to the destruction of the oak, he may have destroyed a temple of Woden at Kestersberg.

Boniface then continued to the area near Wannfried to the Stuffenberg (now called Hulfensberg), where the image of the god Stuffo stood. Stuffo would have been honored in Thuringia, Upper Franconia, and the Harz range in Lower Saxony (GardenStone 482). The image served as an oracle. Boniface cursed and banished Stuffo, driving him into a hole, which is still called a “Stuffo hole” in German today (GardenStone 483).

After destroying the oracle of Stuffo, Boniface planned to destroy an image of Fortune near present-day Gottingen. Enough of a large crowd of Pagans was able to assemble to deter Boniface to follow through on his assault. Instead, though, he destroyed images of Reto, Biel, and Astaroth (the accuracy of some of the non-Germanic names is questionable). The Saxons had been able to move the image of Viel, but Boniface followed them and destroyed the image at the new site. He then went on to destroy the Lar, which was a temple of Lohra. After that, he went on to destroy the image of Jecha, who was likely a goddess associated with the hunt.

While we know Dunner well due to more attestations surviving into the current era, we may never know the other deities as well as did the forebears. We will, though, continue our research and our In a form of irony, though, the lore of those who attempted to eliminate these deities has actually provided the means to restore honor to their names. Thus, let us speak their names again.

Der Aaruf - The Invocation

Beloved Gods and Goddesses! Your names, images, and reputations have been besmirched by zealots, and Your connection to Your people have been severed. Today we restore that connection. Today we invite You back into our lives. We invite You to join us today and to be our honored Guests!

Let us again speak Your names with reverence and honor:

Dunner/Thor
Stuffo
Lohra
Jecha
Reto
Biel

Hail!

Es Opfer un Die Eed - Offerings and Oaths

*Losst uns enniche Opfer uff der Aldaar adder in 's Feier yetz schtelle
Un wann ennichebber hot en Eed zu bschweere, kumm yetz voraa.*

*If anyone has any offerings, please place them onto the altar, or, later, into the fire.
If anyone has any oaths to take, come forward now.*

Eed/ Oaths: *Any oaths should be cleared with the ritual's leadership prior to public expression.*

Die Heiliching vun de Opfer - Hallowing of the Offerings

*Zu Eich, beliebte Ziewe
Mir hewwe die Seidel aa
Mir biede Met un Seider aa
Un gewwe die do annere Gschenker
Wie 'n Zeichnis zu unserer Dankbaardeet
un vun unserer Gemeeschaft
Darrich Eich binne mir uns fescht aa
Losst 's immer so sei!*

*To Ye, beloved Gods and Goddesses
We lift the Stein
We offer mead and cider
And give these other gifts
As a symbol of our gratitude
And of our community
Through Ye we bind ourselves fast
May it always be so!*

*Heel Dunner!
Heel Stuffo!
Heel Lohra!
Heel Jecha!
Heel Reto!
Heel Viel!
Heel zu de Vorgenger!
Heel zu de Noochkummer!
Heel zu de Landwichde!
Heel die Gemeeschaft!*

*Hail Thor!
Hail Stuffo!
Hail Lohra!
Hail Jecha!
Hail Reto!
Hail Viel!
Hail to the ancestors!
Hail to the descendants!
Hail to the Landwights!
Hail to the community!*

Die Ausdeeling - The Distribution

Sege Round: Pass stein and then pour into bowl; use libation to draw runes on the foreheads of participants or sprinkle libations on their heads.

Der Sege - The Blessing

When pouring the libations, all say (choose either language):

*Vun de Ziewe zu der Erd zu uns
Vun uns zu der Erd zu de Gedder*

*From the gods to the Earth to us
From us to the Earth to the gods*

*'N Gschenk fer 'n Gschenk
Heele!*

*A gift for a gift.
Hail!*

Zum Schluss - In Closing

*Heit effne mir zugemachte Diere
un baue do en sctandhafliches Bindnis zamme
Mit de Ziewe
Un darrich unserer allgemee Zweck
Losst uns zamme immer sctarricker waxe.
Der Sege iss beschlosse waerre.*

*Today we open closed doors
and build here a steadfast alliance together
with these Deities
And through our common purpose
Let us all grow stronger together.
This Sege is closed.*

Zu de Wichde - To The Wights

*Mir gewwe aa en Opfer zu de Wichde
Vun desem Land
Un mir bedanke uns 'ne
Fer ihrer Schirm*

*We give also an offering to the Wights
of this Land
And we are thankful to them
For their protection*

Heel!

Hail!

Resources cited:

GardenStone, [Gods of the Germanic Peoples](#) (two volumes). Norderstedt, Germany: Books on Demand, 2014.

Hope, Anne. [Conversion of the Teutonic race; S. Boniface and the conversion of Germany](#). London: R. Washbourne, 1872.